

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 53055.91 ▲ 155.84 0.29%

NASDAQ 26121.16 ▲ 1.1%

STOXX 600 650.50 ▼ 0.3%

10-YR. TREAS. yield 4.479%

OIL \$68.55 ▼ \$0.14

GOLD \$4,155.10 ▲ \$42.40

EURO \$1.1442

YEN 162.09

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Jet fuel prices** are down 40% from their peak in April amid the Iran war, but analysts say airfares aren't likely to follow as long as travelers keep paying up. **A1**
- ◆ **Davos founder** Klaus Schwab is trying to make a comeback at the World Economic Forum after resigning as chair last year amid a probe into misconduct allegations. **A1**
- ◆ **Microsoft said it** will cut some 3,200 jobs from its Xbox videogames division as the company restructures the struggling business. **B1**
- ◆ **Samsung projected** a 19-fold surge in second-quarter operating profit, signaling that its record earnings streak is set to continue amid the AI boom and red-hot demand for chips. **B1**
- ◆ **Large U.S. banks** have been exploring an acquisition that could allow them to get around one of the laws they hate the most: the limits on fees they earn on debit-card transactions. **B1**
- ◆ **Shares of London-listed** EasyJet soared nearly 10% after the budget carrier said it had agreed to a \$7 billion takeover by Castlflake. **B2**
- ◆ **Toyota will spend** \$3.6 billion to bring production of its Tacoma pickup back to the U.S. from Mexico by 2030. **B3**
- ◆ **Walmart is cutting** prices on thousands of items to help customers with affordability after years of inflation. **B3**
- ◆ **SK Hynix**, a South Korean chip maker, kicked off the process for a U.S. listing that seeks to raise \$28 billion in fresh capital. U.S. stocks rose with the Dow, S&P 500 and Nasdaq gaining 0.3%, 0.7% and 1.1%, respectively. **B9**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump confirmed** that he called FIFA's president and asked him to review U.S. striker Folarin Balogun's one-game World Cup suspension, a move that set off an uproar among soccer fans across the globe. **A3**
- ◆ **Democratic Party leaders** and close allies urged Graham Platner to quit the Maine Senate race, after a woman he had been romantically involved with alleged that he sexually assaulted her, an allegation he denied. **A4**
- ◆ **Iran's Islamic Revolutionary** Guard Corps fired missiles at two commercial ships near the Strait of Hormuz, according to a senior U.S. official, marking a major escalation that threatens to complicate negotiations to end the war. **A7**
- ◆ **Prosecutors seeking** the death penalty in the killing of conservative activist Charlie Kirk began laying out their evidence as they push for a murder trial. **A3**
- ◆ **U.N. Secretary-General** António Guterres called for lethal autonomous weapons to be banned. **A3**
- ◆ **Russia's latest** missile attack on Kyiv exposed a grim reality: Ukraine has virtually run out of Patriot interceptors that stop ballistic missiles. **A5**
- ◆ **China's military said it** test-launched a long-range ballistic missile from a nuclear submarine, a rare display of advanced capabilities that set off concerns from the U.S.'s regional allies. **A5**
- ◆ **Netanyahu's bid** to survive as Israel's prime minister is running up against support for a political newcomer. **A7**

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Belgium Ends U.S. Run for the World Cup



LUKE HALESGETTY IMAGES

TOO LATE: U.S. goalkeeper Matt Freese reacts as Belgium celebrates a goal at the World Cup soccer match in Seattle Monday. **A3, A12**

Changing Face of War Poses New Tests for Military Powers

Flexibility is key as drones, AI and cheap missiles upend how battles are waged

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

The way wars are fought is changing fast, as new technologies upend military doctrines on everything from procurement to executing operations. But just how radical will this transformation be in years to come? And are the hundreds of billions of dollars being in-

vested by the U.S., its allies and rivals in new tanks, planes and warships going to become the equivalent of buying horses and arrows on the eve of machine guns and howitzers? The war between Russia and Ukraine was initially dismissed by many Western military leaders as a conflict that didn't hold many lessons for them because the U.S. and allies, should they fight, would have air superiority and powerful precision munitions for a quick, devastating blow. The failure of the U.S. and Israel to inflict a strategic defeat on a

middle power like Iran, after expending a large share of these precision munitions, has undermined that notion. Drone-centered warfare, and with it the accessibility of abundant cheap precision munitions, is here to stay. So is the spread of other capabilities, such as long-range ballistic and cruise missiles, that used to be the preserve of major powers and, even for them, were too expensive for mass use. Meanwhile, the development of autonomous systems guided by artificial intelligence heralds an even more

momentous turn. In the wars of today, what used to be the safe rear hundreds of miles away from the front line is now contested—be it at U.S. bases in the Persian Gulf or Russian military installations far from Ukraine. The proliferation of cheap sensors has also made any massed maneuver, such as an armored thrust akin to the U.S. assault

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- ◆ **U.N. chief urges a ban on** AI 'killer robots' **A3**
- ◆ **Europe races to plug** NATO's gaps **A6**

Founder Plots Return to Davos Forum

By EMILY GLAZER

Klaus Schwab is trying to make a comeback at the World Economic Forum. The 88-year-old founder recently sent letters to board members with a list of demands, legal threats and a request for an advisory role that would give him a say in appointing the Forum's future leadership, according to docu-

ments viewed by The Wall Street Journal. Schwab resigned as chair of the Forum—which hosts an annual meeting in January in Davos, Switzerland—last year after a public clash with the board for its opening of an investigation into a whistleblower's allegations of misconduct. A Journal investigation in 2024 uncovered evidence of a toxic cul-

ture at the Forum for women and Black employees. Schwab denied any wrongdoing. Schwab's justification is anchored, in part, on the Forum last year saying it found no "material wrongdoing" in a public statement after the investigation into the complaints of unauthorized spending and inappropriate treatment of female staffers. Documents reviewed by the

Journal show that the August 2025 statement was at odds with findings that were privately shared with the board by lawyers conducting the probe. Those included instances of discrimination and bullying, misuse of corporate funds and breaches of data integrity. Schwab asked that some of those significant findings not be made public, a decision some

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Movin' In: Kids in 20s Are Living Back Home

By REBECCA PICCIOTTO AND NICHOLAS G. MILLER

Samantha Stobo was fresh off a breakup and unable to afford her Manhattan two-bedroom alone. So the 29-year-old decided to move in with her mom in Miami until she could get back on her feet. She told herself it would only take a few months. Now 33 years old, Stobo has no plans to move out. "I thought it was going to be temporary," Stobo said. "But it's been three years now, and I love it." Living at home as a 20-something was once viewed as a failure to launch and even a source of embarrassment. That's no longer the case, as it is now often viewed as a sign of financial prudence, and for some, a long-term prospect. Chronically high living costs are helping reshape the milestones of early adulthood in America. The national median home price hovers above

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Couples detail what it took to stage their very expensive weddings. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Krispy Kreme is hand-decorating doughnuts in quest to lure younger customers. **B1**

Bank Merger's Big Sticking Point: The Right Way to Make Chili

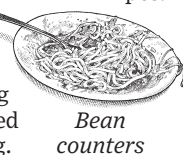
Fifth Third's purchase of Comerica raises big question for leaders: beans or no beans?

By BEN GLICKMAN

Big corporate tie-ups are always delicate affairs, involving integrating systems, replacing signs and branding and making sure a newly combined workforce gets along.

But a nearly \$11 billion bank deal last year has an added sticking point: chili recipes. Following Cincinnati lender Fifth Third's acquisition of Texas-based Comerica Bank, employees from differ-

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Bean counters

Iran War Has Oil-Rich Alaska In Pain Over \$9 Gas

Trump agenda poised to boost industry, but Alaskans face high prices at pump

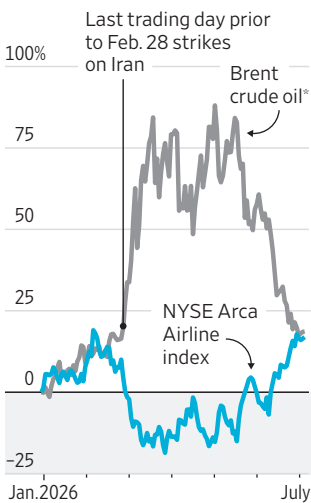
By BENOÎT MORENNE

DILLINGHAM, Alaska—John Stelling had just cranked the digits of his fuel pump to \$9.10 at his gas station in this remote Alaskan community when he realized he had a problem. Could he push the meter to \$10 if he had to? "Not sure if it'll handle those," he said of double-digit fuel prices. In rural Alaska, the war with Iran has led to some of the highest fuel prices in the nation. Remote towns and villages aren't connected to the road system, so they pay hefty premiums to procure gasoline, heating oil and diesel for cranking out electricity. Fuel typically arrives by barge in the summer, when ice clears from waterways. The last barge to unload sets

the price until the next delivery—months away. Many communities had no choice this year but to place their orders in the spring, just as the Iran war sent prices soaring. That means that even if the U.S. and Iran reach a peace deal and the Strait of Hormuz reopens permanently, rural Alaskans will be stuck with exorbitant energy prices long after they have come down for the rest of the country. "The small scale of rural Alaska works against them, the distances work against them," Gov. Mike Dunleavy said in an interview. "It could end up being a tough fall and winter." Alaska's plight is a paradox given its vast fossil-fuel resources—and its place at the heart of President Trump's

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Year-to-date performance



*Continuous contract Source: FactSet